announced by the Government in 1950 itself and further expanded in 2002 (*which we will see in the next sub-title*).

PLANNING COMMISSION

Once the National Planning Committee published its Report (1949) and there was a firm inclusion of the need for 'Economic and Social Planning'[40] in the Constitution, the stage was set for the formal launching of planning in the country. Though the economy was run on the principles of planning very much after the independence itself[41] it was in a piecemeal manner only. For formal planning to begin, for the whole economy at national level, there was a need for a permanent expert body which could take over the responsibility of the whole gamut of planning i.e. plan formation, resource aspects, implementation and review—as planning is a technical[42] matter. Thus, in March 1950[43] the Planning Commission (PC) was set up by the Government by Cabinet Resolution (without resorting to legislation). Important details regarding the composition, legal status, etc. of the PC are as under:

(i) An ***extra-constitutional*** (i.e. non-constitutional) and ***non-statutory*** body (though planning originates from the Constitution there is no reference to the PC in it).

(ii) An ***advisory body*** to the Government of India on an array of issues of economic development.

(iii) A 'think tank' on economic development with the Prime Minister as its ex-officio Chairman and with the provision or a Deputy Chairman.[44] The main function of the Deputy Chairman is to ***co-ordinate*** the work of the Commission.[45]

(iv) Has an open provision for the number of its membership (as many area experts are required by the particular proposed period of planning) other than six Union Cabinet Ministers as its ***ex-officio members***[46] and a Member Secretary. The Minister of Planning is already an ex-officio member of the PC.[47]